

OXYBENZONE

_____Name

_____Date

also called...**benzophenone-3**, 2-hydroxy-4-methoxy-benzophenone, or 2-benzoyl-5-methoxyphenol. It has trade names Eusolex 4360, Escalol 567, and Cyasorb UV9.

What is it?

Oxybenzone is an ultraviolet absorber used for sun protection. It is widely incorporated into make-ups, sunscreens, lip balms, hair products, plastics, and textiles. It is added to some perfumes for its rose-like scent.

Where might it be found?

Facial cleanser, scrub
Facial moisturizer
Anti-wrinkle cream
Moisturizer, cream, lotion
Bath or body oil
Shampoo
Hair conditioner
Hair gel, mousse, hair spray
After-shave
Make-up foundation, concealer
Lipstick, lip balm, lip gloss
Nail polish
Perfume, cologne, skin spray
Sunscreen, sunblock
Insect repellent and sunblock

If you are allergic to oxybenzone, you should not take by mouth the closely related anti-inflammatory agents ketoprofen and tiaprofenic acid, or the cholesterol lowering drug fenofibrate.

Potential cross-reactions:

Some persons who are sensitive to oxybenzone will also react to **dioxybenzone** or to **sulisobenzene**, also called **benzophenone-4**. Some individuals develop an allergic reaction to oxybenzone only on exposure to sunlight.

Some industrial uses of oxybenzone:

Color preserver in paints and varnishes
Color retainer in fluorescent lacquers
Protection against fading in textiles and plastics
Color preserver in dental composite fillings
Product for drug, dye, pesticide manufacture
Car wash gel
Component of clear protective window shades
UV protectant in polystyrene, acrylic, and rubber

How to avoid it:

To avoid oxybenzone check the complete ingredient list of each product you use. For products already at home that do not list ingredients, go to the store and inspect the original box or package.

Some products' ingredient lists are available on the internet at the manufacturer's website, the store's website, or at websites such as <http://householdproducts.nlm.nih.gov>, <http://www.cosmeticsdatabase.com>, or <http://www.drugstore.com>.

You may be exposed to oxybenzone through contact with a partner who uses products that contain it. Ask your hairdresser, masseuse, barber, physician, and nurse to avoid using oxybenzone in your care.

To identify possible workplace exposure, check the Material Safety Data Sheet (MSDS) and ingredient labels of all products encountered. It may be necessary to contact the manufacturer to learn if this sunscreen is present in a commercial product. If you cannot eliminate contact, wear protective gloves.